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Application: Platform Engineer

Dear TOMRA Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Platform Engineer position because it brings together the areas in which I can contribute most effectively: CI/CD infrastructure, mixed Linux and Windows environments, Kubernetes, platform automation, and secure support for software and machine-learning workloads. My experience at STRABAG and Vaillant, together with my AI Platform Operator and on-premises Kubernetes projects, has prepared me to help TOMRA build reliable engineering platforms that allow developers to deliver software faster and more securely.

At STRABAG, I maintained and improved GitLab CI/CD pipelines that ran on Linux and Windows runners for C++/CMake-based embedded software. I diagnosed build, dependency and runner-environment failures, automated the packaging of .bin, .tar.gz, and flashinfo artifacts, and integrated JUnit/XML test reporting to provide developers with clear feedback. I also supported the migration from Perforce to Git/GitLab and created setup and troubleshooting runbooks that reduced dependency on individual knowledge. This experience is directly relevant to operating TOMRA's build servers, GitLab services and shared R&D tooling for software running on real industrial machines.

My AI Platform Operator project demonstrates my ability to build infrastructure for machine-learning delivery rather than treating Kubernetes as an isolated technology. I implemented GitOps-based deployments using Argo CD, Helm and Kustomize; model serving with KServe; and S3-compatible model storage with MinIO. Vault KV v2 and External Secrets Operator provide controlled secret distribution, while Kubernetes RBAC, NetworkPolicies and TLS establish least-privilege security boundaries. The CI/CD workflows automate validation, testing and container builds while incorporating vulnerability scanning, SBOM generation and artifact provenance. This gives development and ML teams a repeatable, secure path from source code and model artifacts to deployed workloads.

I have also built an on-premises platform environment using Proxmox, virtual machines and Kubernetes. It includes dedicated control-plane and worker nodes, Linux and Windows systems, CI/CD runners, GitOps delivery and a Prometheus, Grafana, and Loki observability stack. Working directly with compute, storage, networking, virtualization and cluster services has strengthened my ability to troubleshoot across platform layers, an important capability when maintaining build infrastructure, AI hardware, virtual machines and shared engineering services.

At Vaillant, I worked with Python-based distributed services communicating through TCP/IP, TLS and WebSocket, automated delivery through Azure DevOps, validated workloads in AKS and investigated service health using Grafana and Datadog. Combined with my Terraform, Ansible, Bash, Python and PowerShell experience, this enables me to automate repetitive operations, investigate incidents systematically and translate recurring problems into maintainable platform improvements.

TOMRA particularly appeals to me because the platform is directly connected to sensor-based machines with measurable environmental impact. I would bring a hands-on and structured approach to strengthening your CI/CD and R&D infrastructure, improving platform observability and security, and giving software and machine-learning teams dependable self-service capabilities.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience can contribute to TOMRA's platform engineering team.

Yours sincerely,
Anselem Okeke